

Nothing Lazy About It

Becoming The Lazy Creator in Six Months

PROMPT:

Create an
Activity vault
for childhood
educators

```
import os
from dotenv import load_dotenv
from openai import OpenAI

load_dotenv()
client = OpenAI()

def generate_script(topic):
    prompt = """
    Create an Activity vault for
    childhood educators
    """

    response = client.chat.completions.create(
        model="gpt-4o",
        messages=[{"role": "user", "content": prompt}]
    )
    return response.choices[0].message.content
}

def generate_voiceover(script):
    response = client.audio.speech.create(
        model="tts-1",
        voice="alloy",
        input=script
    )
```

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Six months ago, the person telling this story was on unemployment.

He'd been laid off from his job as a Building Manager at Homestead Land Holdings, no warning, no soft landing, just the kind of ordinary bad news that rearranges the next several months of your life. He'd just moved to Guelph. New city, new chapter, and now no job to build one around.

His resume had nothing on it about technology, software, or building anything digital. What it had was kitchens. Line cook, dishwasher, sous chef, manager, the kind of work where you're on your feet for ten hours and nobody's asking whether you have a portfolio, they're asking whether the ticket is up.

None of that is a small thing to walk away from. And it's exactly the point. This isn't the version of the story where the guy already had a computer science degree and a side project quietly compounding for years before he "made it." This is the version where the guy had a spatula and a shift schedule, and then he didn't, and somewhere in that gap, something else got built instead.

Because here's the other thing about those six months, and about the years leading into them: life had not been easy. There had been seasons difficult enough that they nearly broke him completely. What got him through wasn't a five-year plan or a mentor with the right connections. It was faith. That wasn't a new development that showed up conveniently once the business started working. It was already the foundation everything else in this story gets built on top of.

So was Tatianna, his wife. Twenty years into a career in early childhood education, she wasn't a bystander to any of this. She was the reason the first real product existed at all.

From a Hot Tub in Banff to a Real Company

The idea that became The Lazy Creator started small and specific: instead of learning to code by hand over years, direct AI tools to build the thing, verify every step, ship it, and let the next idea reveal itself once the first one existed.

That single shift, from "I have to learn to do this myself" to "I can direct this to get done correctly," is the entire method this story keeps demonstrating, chapter after chapter, product after product. Not lazy in the sense of avoiding work. Lazy in the sense of refusing to do work that doesn't need to be done by hand anymore.

The first real product to come out of it was adaptED, an educator activity dashboard built alongside Tatianna, using her twenty years of classroom experience as the actual foundation. It

would later grow into the Activity Vault: 5,330 activities across six modules, sold to individual educators and licensed to entire schools, and to date the one asset in the whole portfolio that isn't pre-revenue.

Not every idea landed. A thirty-pack content studio got overextended before it had proof of demand. Other concepts got shelved entirely, technical friction, timing, or simply not being the right idea yet. That's not a footnote to the story, it's a real chapter in it. Learning by failing fast, in public, on a live business, turned out to be a far better teacher than waiting until everything felt certain before starting.

What Actually Got Built

In the months since, the company took real shape:

The Activity Vault — the flagship educator product, priced for individuals and schools, built with a give-back program most people never notice on the way to checkout.

Client websites — starting as mockups built purely to prove capability, then landing a first real paying client, Double Treble Stitches, live, hand-coded, no template. Faithful with a little led directly to being entrusted with more.

Safe Passage — the most demanding build in the entire portfolio. A faith-forward mental health platform for men, built around a feature called The Listener that recognizes crisis language in real time and responds before a conversation escalates into something worse. The stakes on that one are as real as software gets.

Kingdom Radar — a faith content intelligence tool, built out, then deliberately paused, not abandoned, to make room for a project closer to home: a voice-narrated storybook app built specifically for Tatianna, using the exact expertise that built the Activity Vault in the first place, pointed at a different format entirely.

The Faith Library — now the TLC Library — a growing shelf of devotional journals and, now, this very book: the origin story itself, added to the same shelf as everything else that got built along the way.

None of that happened because the starting point was strong. It happened because the starting point mattered far less than everyone assumes it does.

What This Book Actually Is

Nothing Lazy About It is the full account, chapter by chapter: the layoff, the first idea, the failures that taught more than the wins did, and the products that are live and generating revenue right now. It's not a highlight reel. The Studio overreach is in there. The paused projects are in there. The parts that took longer than expected, or didn't work the first time, are in there too.

It's built around one thesis: **you don't need the degree, and you don't need the years of side-project code quietly compounding while a day job pays the bills. You need an idea worth building, the willingness to describe it clearly enough for the right tools to make it real, and the humility to let the first version be wrong, learn from it fast, and build the next version better.**

Six months ago, this was one guy, one layoff, and one idea turning over in his head. It's not that anymore. It won't stay whatever it is right now, either.

Nothing lazy about it. Go build something.

The full book, all ten chapters, is available now for \$7 in the TLC Library.